Project Charter Template

Agile Software Engineering Capstone

Document field	Team entry
Project title	Savings Management
Team name	Stack Underflow
Team members	Zane, Jeff, Jaron, Saw
Project manager or team lead	Zane
Project sponsor	Commerce Bank
Customer or client	Commerce Bank, Bank Users
Instructor	Shah, Syed Jawad Hussain
Start and target end dates	[Enter the course project dates]
Version status and date	0.1 Draft, September 23, 2026

Revision history

Version	Date	Author	Change and approval
0.1	[Date]	Zane,Jeff,Jaron, Saw	Initial draft
1.0	11/2/2026	Zane	[What changed and who approved it]

1 Project Purpose and Authorization

This section explains why the project should exist and gives the team authority to proceed. Describe the problem before proposing detailed features.

1.1 Problem or opportunity

Most people find it difficult to allocate money for saving purposes while still managing their everyday buying expenses. It becomes hard to track how one is progressing towards his or her financial goals when there is no set plan of savings, and there is no definite goal being worked towards. There may not be much awareness on the part of the user as to how close he or she is to achieving the savings goal.

1.2 Project justification

Decision test	Team explanation	Evidence or source
Needed	The project meets the need for an easy way for users to save toward their emergency funds and personal finance goals.	Team brainstorming: Commerce Bank financial component requirement
Feasible	The project can be completed within a semester because it is a fully defined full-stack app that uses React, Bootstrap, ASP.NET Core, C#, and SQLite. We will use simulated financial transactions rather than real banking connections.	Team of 4, End of semester deadline, Commerce bank defined requirements, Commerce bank/professor for support
Optimum	Through this project, there will be the ability to demonstrate front-end development, back-end development, database development, authentication, financial business logic, testing, and deployment without engaging in actual financial transactions through the project.	Fully functional web-app outlined by requirements

1.3 Product vision

This application works as an online financial management tool to help people save their money to reach financial goals. This app will receive data from the user about their spending and give feedback on how to improve their savings. These savings will be used to contribute to an emergency fund with a user set goal (ex: $1000). Then once the wishlist goal has been reached, the user can then create their own savings wishlists and put money away for these wishlists (ex: garage,gaming,gifts,etc). Wish lists will notify the user when savings has reached an amount that is equal to or greater than an item on the wishlist. History of transactions, savings, goals, etc will be viewable by the user.

1.4 Authority to proceed

Authorization item	Entry
Decision	Revision required
Conditions	Finalize the scope, confirm team roles, establish the technology and stack, such as GitHub repos, and get feedback from the professor on the proposed financial workflow before implementation.
Authority granted	Once the professor approves, we can proceed with the requirements, planning, architecture of the project, API design, database design, Sprint 1, and so on.

2 Stakeholders and Team Authority

Identify everyone who can affect the project or is affected by its outcome. Record their needs and decision authority so the team knows whom to consult.

2.1 Stakeholder register

Stakeholder or group	Interest needs or expectations	Decision or contribution	Contact or review cadence
Project sponsor	Entire project, documentation, progress reports, web-app	Course expectations and evaluation	Professor, Scheduled reviews and submission feedback
Client	Finished and fully functional financial web-app	Sponsor alignment and technical feedback	Commerce Bank. Midsemester review, questions, and final walkthrough
Target users	Normal persons wanting to save more money in their day-to-day life	Feedback on UI, usability, real world functionality	Interview(s) with regular persons
Instructor	Teamwork, project development process, documentation, goals	Clarifies course scope and assesses work	Office hours or course channel
Student team	Clear responsibilities and workable collaboration	Builds, tests, documents, and demonstrates the product	Team channel and meeting schedule
[Other stakeholder]	[Needs and expectations]	[Decision or contribution]	[Contact or cadence]

2.2 Team roles and responsibilities

Team member	Primary role	Charter responsibility	Decision authority or backup
Zane	Function Logic	application behavior with backend	[Decision area or backup person]
Jeff	Backend/Database	Database design, SQL/SQLite, Entity Framework Core, backend data layer	[Decision area or backup person]
Jaron	Frontend UI, Documentation	UI design, project documentation	[Decision area or backup person]
Saw	API, Unit Testing	Core Web API testing, xUnit/JUnit tests, API integration,	[Decision area or backup person]

2.3 Decision and escalation rules

The group makes decisions on technical and design aspects through discussions and agreements among themselves. Every individual can make his/her decision within his/her individual domain, but any major changes in terms of structure, scope, scheduling, or important features would be discussed collectively. In case of lack of consensus, then the group leader would help in making the decision and consult the project sponsor or the instructor, as per the need.

3 Goals Objectives and High Level Features

Goals describe the desired direction. Objectives make the expected outcomes specific and measurable. Features identify the main functions that deliver value to the client or users.

3.1 Project goals

Goal ID	Goal statement	Why it matters
G-01	Develop a usable full-stack financial savings application	Web-app needs to be functional in order to provide value
G-02	Helps users organize and monitor progress toward savings goals	Core purpose of web-app
G-___	[Additional goal if needed]	[Value]

3.2 Measurable objectives

Objective ID	Specific measurable objective	Target date	How the team will verify it
OBJ-01	Full stack Web-app hosting success. Full communication with Front-end and Back-end	[Date or sprint]	Users can use web-app, web-app receives/sends information from/to the database. Login success.
OBJ-02	Functionality of financial savings component	[Date or sprint]	All outlined functions of the financial component are reached. (Savings goal, budgeting, etc)
OBJ-___	[Additional objective]	[Date or sprint]	[Verification method]

3.3 High level features

Feature ID	Client valued feature	Primary user or stakeholder	Priority
F-01	Account Creation/Deletion	User	Must
F-02	Existing user log in	User	Must
F-03	Web-page navigation	User	Must
F-04	Saving user information into database	Stakeholder	Must

4 Scope Priorities and Deliverables

4.1 Scope boundaries

In scope	Out of scope
Login & Register page, home page & dashboard, User profile & settings, AI element	[Explicit exclusions and deferred capabilities] Real web server deployment, Real User data in the database
Emergency Savings page, Wishlist page, User account balance, Financial tracking (User provided), Financial Feedback	Real banking connections, real money movement, and real card data unless the sponsor explicitly changes the brief
Manual category-level financial entries such as reporting income and expense summaries, subject to final workflow confirmation	No automatic import of every purchase or transaction from a real financial institution.

4.2 Project priorities

Rank the priorities from 1 to 3. Use each rank once, then explain the tradeoff rule.

Priority area	Rank	Team agreement
Scope and product value	2	Core savings financial component functionality must be maintained, Core user functionality must be maintained. Additional features such as notifications, account details, etc may be neglected in favor of higher priority features/functionality
Schedule and course deadlines	1	Deadlines will affect decisions on depth of features and priority of implementation
Quality and technical standards	3	Web-app is fully functional, No breaking bugs, fully usable by inexperienced user

4.3 Major deliverables and milestones

ID	Milestone or deliverable	Tangible evidence	Target date or sprint	Owner	Reviewer
M-01	Project charter approved	Approved charter	Sprint 0	[Name]	[Sponsor or instructor]

M-02	Requirements baseline	Use cases, FRs, NFRs, and traceability	[Date or sprint]	[Name]	[Reviewer]
M-03	Architecture candidate reviewed	Architecture document and decision record	[Date or sprint]	[Name]	[Reviewer]
M-04	Midsemester increment	Working product increment and feedback notes	[Date or sprint]	[Name]	[Reviewer]
M-05	Feature complete	Testable release candidate	[Date or sprint]	[Name]	[Reviewer]
M-06	Final delivery	Application, tests, documents, and presentation	[Date]	[Name]	[Reviewer]

5 Resources Constraints and Assumptions

5.1 Preliminary resource and budget estimate

Estimate resources at a level appropriate for initiation. Student labor can be recorded in person-hours even when no money changes hands.

Resource	Estimated quantity or effort	Estimated cost	Source or availability	Owner
Student effort	4 hours	$0 course labor	Wednesday 10am, Sat/Sun as needed	All
Hosting or cloud services	Dell optiplex(s)	Free	Provided by Zane	Zane
Development tools	VSCode, Google Docs, Canvas,Zoom	Free	Online	All
Equipment or test devices	Student Laptops/PCs	Existing	Individual Team members personal devices for school	All
Other	[Resource]	[$ amount]	[Source]	[Name]

5.2 Constraints

Constraint ID	Limit placed on the product or project	Source	Effect on the team
C-01	Complete the project within the course schedule	Course calendar	The team must adjust scope before missing a required deadline

C-02	Use only fabricated financial and card data	Sponsor brief	The product cannot connect to real accounts or process real money
C-03	[Technology, policy, security, or staffing limitation]	[Source]	[Effect]
C-___	[Additional constraint]	[Source]	[Effect]

5.3 Assumptions and dependencies

ID	Type	Statement	How the team will validate or respond	Owner	Review date
A-01	Assumption	[Condition outside the team's direct control that is currently believed to be true]	[How and when it will be checked]	[Name]	[Date]
D-01	Dependency	Reliance on Commerce Bank feedback, Commerce Bank defined requirements, Team members, and class resources	The team will make decisions when feedback/provided requirements cannot be applied. Team members will fill in each other's roles when situation makes someone unavailable, Youtube/Internet will be used when class resources does not cover a specific topic	[Name]	11/5/2026
[ID]	[Type]	[Statement]	[Validation or response]	[Name]	[Date]

6 Success Criteria Risks and Agile Working Agreement

6.1 Project success criteria

Criterion ID	What success means	Measure or threshold	Evidence	Reviewer
SC-01	User account	User account can be created, stored in DB, and logged into	Demo	Zane
SC-02	Front-end UI	UI is user friendly and accessible	Real world testing	Jaron
SC-03	Fully functional full stack web-app	Front-end fully communicates with backend	Demo	Saw

6.2 Initial risks and obstacles

Risk ID	Potential problem	Likelihood	Impact	First response	Owner
R-01	Deployment in Dell optiplex(s)	Medium	High	Setting up Optiplex in advance to test compatibility before implementation is required	Zane
R-02	Database scaling with SQLlite	Low	Low	Switching to another SQL solution if deployed outside of class project context	Jeff
R-03	User info Cryptography	High	Low	Password hashing and cryptography would be required if deployed in real world.For class context not a high priority	Saw
R-___	[Additional risk]	[Rating]	[Rating]	[Response]	[Name]

6.3 Agile working agreement

Working practice	Team agreement
Sprint length and ceremonies	Sprint length will be one week. We will have standups once a week. We will review our work once a week.
Backlog ownership	Jeff
Definition of done	Minimum code review, testing, documentation, and acceptance conditions
Communication and response time	SMS groupchat, Expected response time same day, Meeting every Wednesday morning
Scope change	Jeff
Conflict or missed commitment	Text reminders, Connecting for discussion,private resolution

7 Approval and Submission Check

Approval confirms that the reviewers understand the project purpose, boundaries, expected outcomes, and initial authority. It does not freeze the entire backlog. Record approved charter changes in the revision history.

7.1 Review decisions

Reviewer	Role	Decision	Conditions or comments	Date

[Name]	Project sponsor	[Approve / Revise]	[Conditions or comments]	[Date]
Shah, Syed Jawad Hussain	Instructor	[Approve / Revise]	[Conditions or comments]	[Date]
Jeff Camp	Student project lead	Yes	none	9/25/2026

7.2 Signatures

Name and role	Signature	Date
[Project sponsor]		
[Instructor]		
[Student project lead]		
[Additional approver if required]		

7.3 Final submission checklist

[ ] The problem or opportunity is clear and does not begin with a predetermined solution.

[ ] The charter explains why the project is needed, feasible, and a responsible use of resources.

[ ] Stakeholders, team responsibilities, and decision authority are clear.

[ ] Goals, measurable objectives, and high level features agree with one another.

[ ] In scope and out of scope boundaries can guide backlog decisions.

[ ] Milestones name tangible deliverables, target dates, owners, and reviewers.

[ ] Constraints, assumptions, dependencies, success criteria, and initial risks are recorded.

[ ] The agile working agreement explains how the team will plan, review, test, communicate, and handle changes.

[ ] Every bracketed prompt has been replaced or removed before submission.

[ ] The version, date, author list, and approval decisions are current.

Recommended filename: TeamName_ProjectCharter_v1.0.docx